



Venu Srinivasan

Chairman, TVS MOTORS
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Feelgood factor is palpable. You can sense it across many sectors throughout the country for the past few weeks. But it is still early days and too fragile a situation.

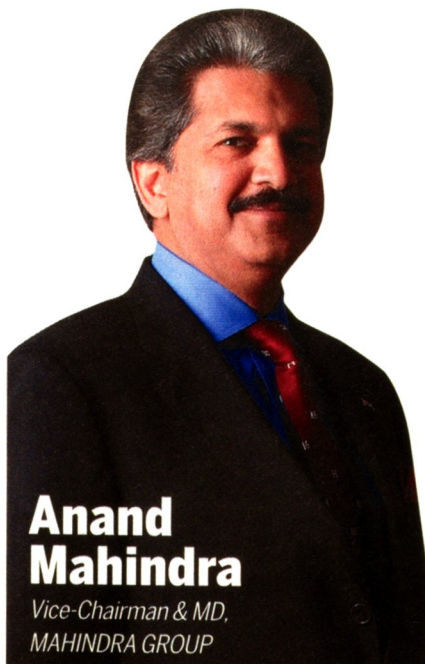
Yes. We can say we have hit the bottom, and while we may take time—till September—to get out, we could look at 6 per cent growth at the end of the year.

I think we are decoupled to a degree. Financial markets are coupled, but certainly recovery in India and China started much earlier and the fear lasted only four or five months.

By September we would definitely see better times. March and April are already better than November and December. The second half clearly would log 6 per cent plus growth.

The first sign is that manufacturing is growing, except for capital goods. Low-cost housing, autos, FMCG and durables are showing signs of double-digit growth. Real growth, when job creation is revived, should come by January.

- Priority should be on controlling fiscal and revenue deficits.
- Reform governance, labour laws and institutions, and weed out subsidies.
- Push disinvestment up to 49 per cent and increase FDI limits in various sectors.



Anand Mahindra

Vice-Chairman & MD,
MAHINDRA GROUP

BANDEEP SINGH

The glimmer may indeed be a ray of light. It's not unanticipated, since it's based on the flywheel of the Indian economy, i.e rural consumption, providing an impetus to growth. Consumer spending is critical and pricing is key as proved by the success of the Xylo.

For India—the domestic economy—the worst is clearly over.

The picture in India is one of light and shade. There will be parts of the economy that are inextricably coupled with the global economy and will move in sync with global recovery.

Parts of the economy driven by rural consumption are already witnessing a turnaround. I had suggested at Davos that the turnaround would come in a couple of months, and happily, I've had no reason for withdrawing that forecast.

Return of investment intent and growth in consumption of core material.

- Initiate a new thrust in infrastructure to boost demand and job creation.
- Push disinvestment—it will bridge the resource gap and boost sentiment.
- Cut interest rates—it will help government cut deficit and boost investment.



Sunil Mittal

Chairman & Managing Director,
BHARTI AIRTEL

DEBASIS PAUL

Our economy—barring a few sectors—was not dependent on external factors for demand. We were hit by general sentiment and vanishing finance, including portfolio and direct investments. But the rural economy was insulated. There are positive signs now.

Yes, certainly. The issue was always about incremental growth. The economy is certainly reviving and should gather pace in the coming months.

The Government's cautious approach on financial sector reforms was a boon. Negligible dependence on global markets for "demand" also led to some degree of "decoupling".

For our economy to reach pre-crisis growth levels and momentum, it should easily take two to three years. Signs of revival, however, are already there and momentum should keep growing in the coming months, provided there are no new external shocks.

New projects and expansions are key. With the requisite price correction in housing and finances trickling back, this sector should revive. With enough liquidity, if entrepreneurial sentiment gets better, revival will be faster.